

KILN OPENING

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VERSION 1.0.4 RULEBOOK

2-4 players | 90-120 minutes | Ages 12+

Plan the workshop. Share the kiln. Master the craft.

A medium-weight worker-placement game about Song Dynasty ceramic workshops.

V1.0.4 design focus A broader but less punishing Fire deck, a more accessible Imperial quality curve, faster Order-display rotation, and a graduated end-game Exhibition tied to Imperial standing.

Complete rules reference

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1. Game Overview

In Kiln Opening, each player directs a ceramic workshop inspired by one of five renowned kiln traditions associated with the Song Dynasty. Your Shifu and Apprentices gather materials, form vessels, apply glazes and decorations, compete for space in a shared kiln, develop specialised craft techniques, and fulfil Market and Imperial commissions.

Worker placement determines what your workshop prepares. The shared firing determines what that preparation becomes. Players influence the kiln through zone choice and secret Wood contributions, while the Fire deck prevents perfect certainty.

Object of the game Score the most Victory Points (VP) from completed Orders, Imperial Progress, the Imperial Seal, kiln-tradition abilities, the end-game Exhibition and remaining Coins. The game lasts exactly five rounds.

Core Strategic Tensions

- Market craft: complete flexible Market Orders to gain Coins and efficient immediate VP.
- Imperial service: complete demanding Imperial Orders to advance Imperial Progress, unlock Apprentices, receive court stipends and improve your Exhibition.
- Workshop development: invest actions and Coins in up to two Craft Techniques that permanently change how your workshop operates.
- Quality mastery: build around Fine and Masterpiece ceramics, recover selected near-misses, and exploit high-quality commissions and Techniques.
- Kiln judgement: choose kiln zones and secret Wood contributions while reading the needs of other players.

Key Terms

Term	Meaning
Ceramic	One Vessel card as it moves through Shaped, Glazed, Fired and Delivered states.
Apprentice	A normal worker that receives the Apprentice effect at an action location.
Shifu	A player's unique master worker. It receives the Shifu effect at an action location.
Technique	A persistent workshop ability acquired at the Guild & Academy.
Preferred Heat	The heat value required by a Glaze: 1, 2 or 3.
Base Heat	Heat 1, 2 or 3, determined by total Wood relative to the number of contributing players.

Term	Meaning
Global Heat	Base Heat plus the revealed Fire-card modifier.
Actual Heat	Global Heat plus the modifier of a ceramic's active kiln space, after applicable abilities.
Heat Difference	The absolute difference between Actual Heat and Preferred Heat.
Order hand	Orders taken but not yet completed.

2. Component Checklist

Component	Qty.	Notes
Central Action Board	1	Six worker-placement locations with capacities by player count.
Shared Kiln Board	1	Eight printed spaces. Use 6 at 2P, 7 at 3P and all 8 at 4P.
Kiln Player Boards	5	Ru, Guan, Ge, Ding and Jun; only 2-4 are used each game.
Shifu Workers	4	One in each player colour.
Apprentice Workers	20	Five per player; three begin available and two are unlocked.
Clay	40	Brown cubes or tokens.
Wood	40	Distinct from Clay.
Coins	50	Values 1 and 5 are useful.
Vessel Cards	40	Eight each: Bowl, Plate, Washer, Vase and Censer.
Market Orders	23	See Appendix A.
Imperial Orders	13	See Appendix A.
Technique Tiles	15	Five Forming, five Glazing and five Firing Techniques.
Fire Cards	20	4 at -2, 3 at -1, 6 at 0, 3 at +1 and 4 at +2.
Wood Contribution Cards	16	Cards 0, 1, 2 and 3 for each player.
Imperial Progress Markers	4	One in each player colour.
VP Markers / Score Pad	4 or 1	Use a score track or paper.
First Player Marker	1	Any distinct marker.
Round Marker	1	Tracks rounds 1 to 5.
Imperial Seal	1	Worth 2 VP to the first player reaching Progress 5.

Vessel cards may be marked in pencil or sleeved and written on with dry-erase pen. Each card needs fields for Glaze, Decoration and Quality.

3. Setup

1. Place the Central Action Board, Shared Kiln, five-round track and Imperial Progress track in the centre of the table.
2. Set each action location to the capacity for the player count. Cover or ignore unused worker spaces.
3. Set active Shared Kiln spaces: at 2 players cover 1 Middle and 1 Low space; at 3 players cover 1 Low space; at 4 players use all 8 spaces.

4. Shuffle the 23-card Market deck and 13-card Imperial deck separately. Reveal 4 Market Orders and 4 Imperial Orders face up.
5. Separate the 15 Techniques into Forming, Glazing and Firing decks of 5. Shuffle each deck and reveal 2 from each discipline.
6. Shuffle the 20-card Fire deck and place it face down with room for a face-up discard pile.
7. Place Clay, Wood, Coins and Vessel cards within reach. Sort Vessel cards by Shape.
8. Each player chooses a colour and takes 1 Shifu, 5 Apprentices, 1 Imperial Progress marker and Wood Contribution cards 0-3.
9. Randomly determine the first player. In reverse turn order, each player chooses an available Kiln Player Board.
10. Each player places their Shifu and 3 Apprentices beside their board as available workers. Set the remaining 2 Apprentices aside as locked.
11. Each player receives 2 Clay, 2 Wood and 3 Coins.
12. Each player draws 1 Market Order. If it requires two or more ceramics, that player may discard it and draw once more.
13. Place all Imperial Progress markers on space 0 and the Round marker on Round 1.

Action Capacity by Player Count

Location	2 Players	3 Players	4 Players
Materials Yard	2	3	4
Forming Studio	2	3	4
Glaze Workshop	2	3	4
Kiln Yard	3	4	5
Market & Imperial Office	2	3	4
Guild & Academy	1	2	3

Order hand limit A player may normally hold up to 3 uncompleted Orders in any combination. Guan may hold 4. Check the limit immediately after each Order is taken. Orders remain in hand until completed and cannot be discarded unless a rule explicitly permits it.

Open Information

- Resources, workers, unfinished ceramics, finished ceramics, Orders, Techniques and Imperial Progress are public.
- Wood Contribution cards are secret until revealed during firing.
- The Fire discard pile and all face-up displays are public.

4. Round Structure

Phase	Name	Summary
1	Start of Round	Rotate Order displays when applicable; ready abilities and refill displays.
2	Work Phase	Players alternate placing workers and resolving actions.
3	Firing Phase	Resolve kiln movement, secret Wood, Base Heat, Fire, abilities and Quality.
4	Order Phase	Players complete eligible Orders in turn order.
5	Cleanup Phase	Return workers, unlock Apprentices, pass First Player and advance the round.

Phase 1 - Start of Round

At the start of Rounds 2, 3, 4 and 5, discard the two leftmost face-up Market Orders and the two leftmost face-up Imperial Orders. Slide the remaining cards left and refill both displays to 4. In Round 1, use the setup displays unchanged.

- Refill any incomplete Order or Technique display.
- Ready all exhausted Technique tiles.
- Reset every once-per-round Kiln Tradition ability.
- The First Player begins the Work Phase.

Phase 2 - Work Phase

Beginning with the First Player and proceeding clockwise, each player places one available worker on an open action space and resolves that action immediately. Continue until every player has placed all available workers or passed.

- An Apprentice receives the Apprentice effect shown at the location.
- The Shifu receives the Shifu effect shown at the location.
- A player may use the same location more than once if spaces remain.
- A player may choose less than the maximum amount allowed, but unused capacity is lost.
- Passing is permanent for the current Work Phase. Unused workers provide no benefit.

Phase 3 - Firing Phase

Resolve the complete procedure in Section 8. If the kiln is empty, skip this phase and do not reveal a Fire card.

Phase 4 - Order Phase

In turn order, each player may complete any number of Orders. Resolve each Order fully before beginning another. An Imperial Order requiring exactly 1 ceramic advances Imperial Progress by 1 space; an Imperial Order requiring 2 or more ceramics advances it by 2 spaces. There is no per-round advancement limit.

Phase 5 - Cleanup Phase

1. Return every placed worker to its owner.
2. For each Imperial Progress milestone at space 1 or 3 reached or passed this round, make the corresponding locked Apprentice available. If both milestones were crossed, unlock both. Newly unlocked Apprentices can act from the next round.
3. Pass the First Player marker clockwise.
4. Advance the Round marker. After Cleanup of Round 5, proceed to final scoring.

Order rotation timing Order displays are not cycled during Cleanup. Their scheduled rotation occurs at the start of Rounds 2-5. Face-up Orders taken during the Work Phase are still refilled immediately.

5. Action Locations

The six locations form a production and development network. Forming, Glazing and Loading are required to finish a ceramic; the scale and timing of those actions remain flexible.

Materials Yard

Worker	Effect
Apprentice	Gain 3 resources in any combination of Clay and Wood.
Shifu	Gain 4 resources in any combination of Clay and Wood.

Forming Studio

Worker	Effect
Apprentice	Pay the normal Clay cost to shape 1 vessel of any Shape.
Shifu	Pay the normal Clay costs to shape up to 2 vessels of any Shapes.

Glaze Workshop

Worker	Effect
Apprentice	Apply 1 Glaze and choose 1 Decoration for 1 shaped vessel. Pay the Decoration cost normally.
Shifu	Choose one: apply Glaze and Decoration to up to 2 shaped vessels, paying normally; or apply Glaze and Decoration to 1 shaped vessel and ignore that Decoration's Coin cost.

Kiln Yard

Worker	Effect
Apprentice	Load 1 glazed ceramic into any empty active kiln space.
Shifu	Load up to 2 glazed ceramics into any empty active kiln spaces.

- The Kiln Yard does not provide Wood.
- Covered kiln spaces are unavailable for the entire game and cannot receive ceramics.
- A loaded ceramic remains in its active space until the Firing Phase unless moved by a Technique.

Market & Imperial Office

Worker	Main action	After the main action
Apprentice	Choose one: take 1 Order (face-up or blind top-card draw from either deck); or gain 2 Coins.	Optionally sell up to 1 Flawed ceramic for 1 Coin.
Shifu	Choose one: take up to 2 Orders; take 1 Order + gain 2 Coins; gain 4 Coins; or use Court Patronage if eligible.	Optionally sell up to 2 Flawed ceramics for 1 Coin each.

Court Patronage - Shifu only As the Shifu's main Office action, if you have completed at least 1 Imperial Order this game, pay 5 Coins to advance Imperial Progress by 1 space. Court Patronage cannot advance you from space 4 to space 5.

- For each Order taken, choose either a face-up Order or the top card of the corresponding deck without looking at it first. Reveal a blind-drawn card immediately.
- When a face-up Order is taken, immediately refill its display position before another Order is taken. A blind top-card draw does not change the display.
- You may not take an Order if doing so would exceed your hand limit.
- Court Patronage is not a normal Office main action for effects that explicitly exclude it, such as Connoisseur Network.

Guild & Academy

Worker	Effect
Apprentice	Pay the printed Coin cost and take 1 face-up Technique tile.
Shifu	Before choosing, you may put 1 face-up Technique on the bottom of its discipline deck and reveal a replacement. Then take 1 face-up Technique for 1 Coin less than printed cost, minimum 1 Coin.

- Immediately refill the Technique display from the same discipline deck.
- A player may own at most 2 Techniques, from the same or different disciplines.
- A newly acquired Technique may be used later in the same round if its timing permits.

6. Ceramic Production

Production Stages

1. Gain Clay and Wood at the Materials Yard.
2. Pay Clay at the Forming Studio and take the appropriate Vessel card.
3. Choose a Glaze and Decoration at the Glaze Workshop.
4. Load the glazed ceramic into an active Shared Kiln space at the Kiln Yard.
5. Resolve the Firing Phase.
6. Use the finished ceramic to complete an Order or include it in the end-game Exhibition.

Historical abstraction Clay cleaning, refining, mixing, drying and other preparation are included in the Forming Studio action. The Shared Kiln represents the decisive firing in which the glaze and body reach their final appearance.

Shapes and Forming Costs

Shape	Clay Cost	Supply
Bowl	1	8
Plate	1	8
Washer	1	8
Vase	2	8
Censer	2	8

If the supply of a Shape is empty, that Shape cannot be formed until a card returns to the supply. Delivered ceramics remain beneath completed Orders and do not return during the game.

Glazes and Preferred Heat

Glaze	Preferred Heat	Role
White	1 - Low	Favours cooler results.
Celadon	2 - Medium	Common in refined and Imperial Orders.
Grey-Green	2 - Medium	Often paired with Crackle.
Moon White	3 - High	Favours stronger firing.

Decorations

Decoration	Cost	Rule
Plain	1 Coin	No additional rule.
Carved	2 Coins	Required by some Orders.
Impressed	2 Coins	Required by some Orders.
Crackle	2 Coins	Required by some Orders; Ge may create it during firing without paying the cost.

Ceramic States

- Shaped: records Shape only.
- Glazed: records Shape, Glaze and Decoration and may be loaded. These cannot change unless an ability explicitly allows it.
- Fired: also records Quality and moves to Finished Ceramics.
- Delivered: placed beneath a completed Order and cannot be used again.
- Second Firing may return a Standard ceramic to Glazed. It keeps Shape, Glaze and Decoration, loses Quality, and its later firing completely replaces the previous result.

7. Craft Techniques

Craft Techniques are permanent workshop developments. They change the value or flexibility of existing actions but never replace the player's Kiln Tradition ability.

- Techniques are divided into Forming, Glazing and Firing disciplines, with exactly 5 tiles in each.
- Six Techniques are face up: 2 from each discipline.
- A player may own at most 2 Techniques.
- Unless noted otherwise, Technique abilities are limited to once per round. Turn the tile sideways when used and ready it at the next Start of Round.
- Techniques provide no direct end-game VP.

Technique Timing Categories

Timing	Examples
During an action	Forming and Glazing Techniques resolve while that action is being resolved.
Before Wood Contributions	Kiln Setting resolves after the Work Phase and before contribution cards are chosen.
After Contributions are revealed	Fuel Ledger resolves before Base Heat is determined.
After Fire is revealed	Sagger Selection resolves after the Fire card is known but before Actual Heat is calculated.

Timing	Examples
After Quality is assigned	Protective Saggars and Second Firing resolve before after-firing rewards.
After a normal Office main action	Connoisseur Network may sell one Masterpiece; it cannot follow Court Patronage.
After firing	Test Pieces, Kiln Records and Ru resolve before ceramics return to their owners.

8. The Shared Kiln and Firing

Player-Scaled Kiln Layout

Players	High (+1)	Middle (0)	Low (-1)	Active Spaces
2	2	2	2	6
3	2	3	2	7
4	2	3	3	8

- At 2 players, cover 1 Middle and 1 Low space.
 - At 3 players, cover 1 Low space.
 - At 4 players, use all 8 spaces.
 - Covered spaces cannot receive ceramics. Kiln Setting or another movement effect cannot move a ceramic into a covered space.
- All ceramics share one Global Heat, but each active space modifies its ceramic's Actual Heat. Active kiln spaces hold one ceramic unless a rule explicitly says otherwise.

Firing Procedure

1. Before Contributions: in turn order from the First Player, resolve optional abilities such as Kiln Setting.
2. Choose Contributions: every player with at least one ceramic in the kiln secretly selects a Wood Contribution card from 0 to 3. The player must possess at least that much Wood. Players with no ceramic do not contribute.
3. Reveal and Spend: reveal all selected cards simultaneously. Each player spends the chosen Wood.
4. Modify Contributions: in turn order, resolve abilities used after contributions are revealed, such as Fuel Ledger.
5. Determine Base Heat: count the number of contributing players, including players who chose 0. Compare total Wood to the Contributor-Scaled Base Heat table.
6. Reveal Fire: reveal the top Fire card and add its modifier (-2, -1, 0, +1 or +2) to Base Heat. This is the unmodified Global Heat. Do not cap the value.
7. After-Fire Abilities: resolve abilities such as Sagger Selection. Sagger Selection changes the Fire modifier only for the chosen ceramic.
8. Calculate Actual Heat: for each ceramic, add its active kiln-zone modifier to the applicable Global Heat.
9. Resolve Before-Quality Abilities: in turn order, resolve abilities such as Jun and Ge.
10. Assign Quality: compare each final Actual Heat to its Preferred Heat and use the Quality table.
11. Resolve After-Quality Abilities: in turn order, resolve abilities such as Protective Saggars and Second Firing.
12. Resolve After-Firing Effects: resolve Test Pieces, Kiln Records and Ru. Return remaining ceramics to Finished Ceramics, empty the kiln and discard the Fire card face up.

Contributor-Scaled Base Heat

Contributing Players	Heat 1 - Low	Heat 2 - Medium	Heat 3 - High
1	0 Wood	1-2 Wood	3+ Wood
2	0-1 Wood	2-4 Wood	5+ Wood
3	0-2 Wood	3-6 Wood	7+ Wood
4	0-3 Wood	4-8 Wood	9+ Wood

General formula With N contributing players: Low if total Wood is less than N; Medium if total Wood is from N through 2N; High if total Wood is greater than 2N.

Quality Table

Heat Difference	Quality	Order Eligibility
0	Masterpiece	Satisfies any minimum Quality.
1	Fine	Satisfies Fine+ and Standard+.
2	Standard	Satisfies Standard+ only.
3 or more	Flawed	Cannot satisfy Orders or the end-game Exhibition.

Natural exact heat match For Test Pieces, determine whether a ceramic naturally matched Preferred Heat using Base Heat, the original revealed Fire modifier and its kiln-zone modifier, before Sagger Selection, Jun, Ge or any other ability changes the result.

Worked Firing Example

Three players have ceramics in the kiln, so the Medium range is 3-6 Wood. They reveal 2, 1 and 0 Wood for a total of 3. Base Heat is 2. The Fire card is +1, so Global Heat is 3. A White bowl in Low has Actual Heat 2 and becomes Fine; a Celadon washer in Middle has Actual Heat 3 and becomes Fine; a Moon White vase in High has Actual Heat 4 and becomes Fine. If the Fire card had been 0, all three would have matched their Preferred Heat naturally and become Masterpieces before abilities.

9. Orders and Imperial Progress

Taking Orders

Orders are taken using the Market & Imperial Office. For each Order taken, choose either a face-up Order from either display or a blind top-card draw from either deck. Reveal a blind-drawn card immediately. If an action allows two Orders, resolve them one at a time and you may stop after the first. Never exceed your Order hand limit.

Completing Orders

- 1. Choose one Order in your hand during your turn in the Order Phase.
- 2. Select the required finished, undelivered ceramics.
- 3. Confirm every Shape, Glaze, Decoration, relationship and minimum Quality requirement. "Any" means no restriction.
- 4. Place used ceramics beneath the completed Order; they cannot be used again.
- 5. Record printed VP immediately, gain printed Coins, and place the completed Order face up in your scoring area.
- 6. If Imperial: advance Progress by 1 for an Order requiring exactly 1 ceramic, or by 2 for an Order requiring 2 or more ceramics. Progress cannot exceed 5.

Market and Imperial Roles

Order Type	Primary Benefit	Typical Pressure
Market	Coins and efficient immediate VP.	More flexible attributes and Quality.
Imperial	Progress, workforce, court stipends and prestige VP.	Stricter combinations and higher minimum Quality.

Imperial Progress Track

Space	Title	Reward When Reached	End-game VP
0	Local Workshop	None	0

Space	Title	Reward When Reached	End-game VP
1	Local Renown	Unlock 1 Apprentice during Cleanup	0
2	Prefectural Recommendation	Gain 2 Coins	2
3	Court Examination	Unlock 1 Apprentice during Cleanup	2
4	Awaiting Audience	Gain 3 Coins; full Exhibition access	4
5	Imperial Audience	Take Imperial Seal if available; full Exhibition access	8

- A completed 1-ceramic Imperial Order advances Progress by 1; a 2+ ceramic Imperial Order advances it by 2. There is no per-round limit.
- Court Patronage provides an additional +1 Progress only after that player has completed at least 1 Imperial Order. It cannot reach space 5.
- When an advance reaches or passes space 1 or 3, mark the corresponding Apprentice milestone. The Apprentice becomes available during Cleanup and can act next round.
- The first time a player reaches or passes space 2, immediately gain 2 Coins. The first time they reach or pass space 4, immediately gain 3 Coins. Each stipend is gained once per player.
- The first player to reach space 5 takes the Imperial Seal, worth 2 VP.
- Reaching space 5 does not end the game.

End-game Exhibition

At game end, every player may exhibit finished, undelivered ceramics of Standard Quality or better. Capacity depends on final Imperial Progress.

Final Progress	Maximum Ceramics	Diversity Bonuses
0-1	1	None
2-3	2	None
4-5	3	Eligible for Shape and Glaze bonuses

Presented Quality	VP
Standard	1
Fine	2
Masterpiece	4

- At Progress 4-5, gain +2 VP if exactly 3 exhibited ceramics have 3 different Shapes.
- At Progress 4-5, gain +2 VP if exactly 3 exhibited ceramics have 3 different Glazes.
- Flawed ceramics cannot be exhibited. There is no penalty for exhibiting fewer than your maximum or none.

10. Kiln Tradition Abilities

Unless stated otherwise, each Kiln Tradition ability may be used once per round and resets at the Start of Round.

Ru Kiln / 汝窑 - Quiet Perfection

After all firing abilities are resolved, if you produced at least one Masterpiece with Celadon glaze and Plain decoration, gain 3 VP. Score this only once per round.

Guan Kiln / 官窑 - Imperial Patronage

Your Order hand limit is 4. Once per round, when you complete an Imperial Order, you may ignore one Decoration requirement on that Order. You must still satisfy all Shape, Glaze, quantity, relationship and Quality requirements.

Ge Kiln / 哥窑 - Crackle from Fire

Once per round, after Actual Heat is calculated but before Quality is assigned, choose one of your ceramics with a heat difference of exactly 1. Treat its heat difference as 0, assign it Masterpiece Quality, and change its Decoration to Crackle without paying the Crackle Decoration cost.

Ding Kiln / 定窑 - Moulded Production

Once per round, when resolving the Forming Studio, after you shape a Bowl, Plate or Washer, you may pay that Shape's normal Clay cost to shape one additional vessel of the same Shape. This additional vessel does not count against the action's normal limit.

Jun Kiln / 钧窑 - Kiln Transformation

Once per round, after Actual Heat is calculated but before Quality is assigned, you may pay 2 Coins to adjust the Actual Heat of one of your ceramics by +1 or -1. This affects only that ceramic.

Ability Timing

- If several players use abilities in the same timing window, resolve them in turn order beginning with the First Player.
- Jun changes Actual Heat, then recalculate that ceramic's heat difference.
- Ge changes the result and Decoration before Quality is assigned; its Crackle change costs no Coins.
- Ru checks its condition only after all Quality adjustments are complete.
- Guan and Ding resolve during the Order or action that triggers them.

11. End of the Game and Scoring

The game ends after completing Cleanup in Round 5. Do not begin another round.

1. Begin with all VP already recorded during play from completed Orders, Kiln Tradition abilities and other immediate effects.
2. Add the end-game VP shown on your final Imperial Progress space.
3. Add 2 VP if you hold the Imperial Seal.
4. Resolve and add your end-game Exhibition.
5. Score 1 VP for every 3 Coins remaining, to a maximum of 5 VP.

The player with the most VP wins.

Tie Breakers

1. The tied player farther along Imperial Progress.
2. The tied player with more completed Imperial Orders.
3. The tied player with more Masterpiece ceramics delivered or exhibited.
4. If still tied, the tied players share victory.

12. General Clarifications

- Resources are limited by the supply. If a supply is empty, receive only what remains.
- Coins may be exchanged freely between denominations.
- Players may not trade resources, Orders, Techniques or ceramics.
- A worker action resolves immediately. Unused action capacity is lost.
- A newly unlocked Apprentice cannot act until the next round.

- Shaped, Glazed and Finished ceramics remain in your workshop between rounds and keep all recorded attributes.
- Only delivered, exhibited or sold ceramics leave the Finished Ceramics area, except a Standard ceramic returned to Glazed by Second Firing.
- A ceramic sold by the Office or Connoisseur Network returns its Vessel card to the matching Shape supply.
- A player may not voluntarily discard a non-Flawed ceramic.
- Uncompleted Orders and unused ceramics have no end-game penalty and score no VP unless another rule scores them.
- VP gained immediately is recorded once and is not scored a second time during final scoring.
- If a Technique deck is empty, do not refill its display unless a tile is returned to that deck.
- Covered kiln spaces are not empty spaces; no loading or movement effect may use them.
- No other special two-player rules are used beyond action capacities, the 6-space kiln layout and contributor-scaled Base Heat.

Appendix A - Complete Order Deck

"Standard+" means Standard, Fine or Masterpiece. "Fine+" means Fine or Masterpiece. Market Orders provide Coins; Imperial Orders provide Progress and no Coins unless printed otherwise. The deck contains 23 Market Orders and 13 Imperial Orders. Display sizes are 4 Market and 4 Imperial.

Market Orders

ID	Ceramics Required	Minimum Quality	VP	Coins
M01	1 Bowl; any Glaze; any Decoration	Standard+	3	3
M02	1 Plate; any Glaze; any Decoration	Standard+	3	3
M03	1 Washer; any Glaze; any Decoration	Standard+	3	3
M04	1 Vase; any Glaze; any Decoration	Standard+	4	4
M05	1 Censer; any Glaze; any Decoration	Standard+	4	4
M06	1 Bowl; White; Plain	Fine+	5	4
M07	1 Plate; Celadon; Plain	Fine+	6	3
M08	1 Washer; Grey-Green; Crackle	Standard+	6	3
M09	1 Vase; Moon White; any Decoration	Fine+	7	4
M10	1 Censer; Moon White; Carved	Fine+	8	4
M11	1 any Shape; White; Carved	Fine+	6	4
M12	1 any Shape; Grey-Green; Impressed	Fine+	6	4
M13	1 any Shape; Grey-Green; Crackle	Fine+	7	3
M14	1 any Shape; Moon White; Impressed	Fine+	7	4
M15	2 Bowls; any Glazes and Decorations	Standard+ each	7	5
M16	1 Bowl + 1 Plate; same Glaze	Standard+ each	8	5
M17	1 Vase + 1 Washer; different Glazes	Standard+ each	9	5
M18	2 different Shapes; same Decoration	Fine+ each	10	4
M19	3 different Shapes; any other attributes	Standard+ each	11	6

ID	Ceramics Required	Minimum Quality	VP	Coins
M20	2 ceramics: one White and one Celadon	Fine+ each	10	5
M21	1 ceramic; any attributes; Masterpiece	Masterpiece	5	5
M22	2 ceramics; different Shapes	Fine+ each	8	4
M23	3 ceramics; different Shapes; at least 2 Glazes	Fine+ each	13	5

Imperial Orders

ID	Ceramics Required	Minimum Quality	VP	Progress
I01	1 Bowl; Celadon; Plain	Masterpiece	7	+1
I02	1 Washer; Celadon; Impressed	Fine+	8	+1
I03	1 Plate; White; Carved	Masterpiece	8	+1
I04	1 Vase; Moon White; Impressed	Fine+	9	+1
I05	1 Censer; Grey-Green; Crackle	Fine+	8	+1
I06	1 Bowl + 1 Plate; same Glaze; at least one Masterpiece	Fine+ each	11	+2
I07	1 Vase + 1 Washer; different Glazes	Fine+ each	12	+2
I08	3 ceramics; all different Shapes	Fine+ each	14	+2
I09	2 ceramics; different Glazes; at least one Masterpiece	Fine+ each	13	+2
I10	1 Bowl + 1 Vase + 1 Censer; all different Glazes	Fine+ each	15	+2
I11	1 Vase or Censer; any Glaze and Decoration	Masterpiece	8	+1
I12	2 ceramics; different Shapes and Glazes	Fine+ each	11	+2
I13	3 ceramics: White, Celadon/Grey-Green, and Moon White	Fine+ each	14	+2

Imperial Progress rule Each completed Imperial Order advances according to size: exactly 1 ceramic = +1 space; 2 or more ceramics = +2 spaces. There is no per-round limit, and Progress cannot exceed 5.

Appendix B - Complete Craft Technique Set

Each Technique is unique. The set contains exactly 5 Forming, 5 Glazing and 5 Firing tiles. Pay its printed cost when acquired at the Guild & Academy, subject to the Shifu discount. Unless noted otherwise, each ability may be used once per round.

Discipline	Technique	Cost	Ability
Forming	Large Throwing Wheel	2	After you form a Vase or Censer, gain 1 Clay.
Forming	Measuring Calipers	2	After you form two different Shapes during the same Forming action, gain 2 Coins.
Forming	Clay Substitution	2	When paying a Forming cost, you may pay 1 Coin instead of 1 Clay.
Forming	Drying Frames	2	After you form a ceramic whose Shape matches at least one uncompleted Order in your hand, gain 1 Coin.
Forming	Kiln Records	3	After firing, if at least 2 of your ceramics are Masterpieces, gain 1 Clay and 1 Coin.
Glazing	Carving Knives	2	Ignore the Coin cost of one Carved Decoration you apply.
Glazing	Seal Stamps	2	Ignore the Coin cost of one Impressed Decoration you apply.
Glazing	Colour Samples	2	Once per round, when you use the Office to take at least one Order, before choosing your first Order you may put 1 face-up Order from either display on the bottom of its deck and reveal a replacement.
Glazing	Connoisseur Network	3	After a normal Office main action, sell 1 finished, undelivered Masterpiece for 5 Coins. It cannot follow Court Patronage.
Glazing	Second Firing	3	After Quality is assigned, return 1 of your Standard ceramics to your Glazed area. Remove its Quality; it may be fired again later.
Firing	Kiln Setting	3	Before Wood Contributions are chosen, move one of your loaded ceramics to any empty active kiln space.
Firing	Protective Saggars	3	After Quality is assigned, pay 1 Coin to improve one ceramic by one level: Flawed to Standard or Standard to Fine. Cannot create Masterpiece.
Firing	Fuel Ledger	3	After Contribution cards are revealed but before Base Heat is determined, pay 1 Coin and spend 1 Wood to increase your contribution by 1.
Firing	Test Pieces	2	After firing, gain 1 Coin if at least one of your ceramics had a natural exact heat match, plus 1 more if at least two did. Max 2 Coins.
Firing	Sagger Selection	3	After the Fire card is revealed, pay 2 Coins to treat its modifier as 0 for one of your ceramics.

Technique Clarifications

- Measuring Calipers: the two Shapes must be different and formed during the same Forming action.
- Clay Substitution: Ding may use it when paying for Ding's additional vessel.

- Colour Samples: triggers once per round before choosing your first Order during an Office action in which you take at least one Order.
- Kiln Records: checks final Masterpiece qualities after firing abilities resolve.
- Connoisseur Network: may follow a normal Office main action, never Court Patronage. The sold Masterpiece returns to its Shape supply.
- Second Firing: preserves Shape, Glaze and Decoration; remove old Standard Quality. The later firing completely replaces it.
- Protective Saggars: improves exactly one level for 1 Coin; cannot improve Fine to Masterpiece.
- Fuel Ledger: may raise effective contribution above 3; contributor count does not change.
- Test Pieces: check the original natural result before Sagger Selection, Jun, Ge or similar effects.
- Sagger Selection: treating Fire as 0 affects only the chosen ceramic.
- Kiln Setting: may move only into an empty active kiln space.

Appendix C - Fire Deck

Modifier	Number of Cards	Probability
-2	4	20%
-1	3	15%
0	6	30%
+1	3	15%
+2	4	20%

The Fire deck uses a symmetric five-value distribution. If a ceramic is exactly aligned with its Preferred Heat before Fire and no ability changes the result, the Fire card alone produces 30% Masterpiece, 30% Fine and 40% Standard, with no Flawed result. Actual game outcomes still depend on Base Heat, kiln zone and abilities.

Appendix D - Quick Reference

Round Sequence

1. Start: in Rounds 2-5 rotate the two leftmost Orders in both displays; refill; ready Techniques and reset abilities.
2. Work: alternate worker placements until all players pass.
3. Fire: pre-contribution abilities, secret Wood, Base Heat, Fire card, after-Fire abilities, Actual Heat, Quality, after-Quality abilities, after-firing rewards.
4. Orders: complete eligible Orders; Imperial Orders give +1 Progress for 1 ceramic or +2 for 2+ ceramics.
5. Cleanup: return workers, unlock Apprentices, pass First Player and advance the round.

Action Summary

Location	Apprentice	Shifu
Materials	Gain 3 Clay/Wood	Gain 4 Clay/Wood
Forming	Shape 1 ceramic	Shape up to 2 ceramics
Glazing	Glaze/decorate 1	Glaze/decorate up to 2; or 1 with free Decoration
Kiln	Load 1	Load up to 2
Office	Take 1 Order or gain 2 Coins; may sell 1 Flawed	Take up to 2 Orders; 1 Order + 2 Coins; gain 4 Coins; or Patronage; may sell up to 2 Flawed
Guild & Academy	Buy 1 Technique at printed cost	May refresh 1; buy 1 Technique at -1 Coin, minimum 1

Kiln Space Summary

Players	High	Middle	Low	Total
2	2 High	2 Middle	2 Low	6
3	2 High	3 Middle	2 Low	7
4	2 High	3 Middle	3 Low	8

Firing Summary

Contributing Players	Heat 1 - Low	Heat 2 - Medium	Heat 3 - High
1	0 Wood	1-2 Wood	3+ Wood
2	0-1 Wood	2-4 Wood	5+ Wood
3	0-2 Wood	3-6 Wood	7+ Wood
4	0-3 Wood	4-8 Wood	9+ Wood

Fire & Quality

Fire Modifier	Cards
-2	4
-1	3
0	6
+1	3
+2	4

Heat Difference	Quality
0	Masterpiece
1	Fine
2	Standard
3+	Flawed

Imperial Summary

- Imperial Orders: +1 Progress for 1 ceramic; +2 for 2+ ceramics; no per-round limit.
- Court Patronage: Shifu only; requires at least 1 completed Imperial Order; pay 5 Coins for +1 Progress; cannot reach space 5 this way.
- Space 1: unlock first Apprentice during Cleanup.
- Space 2: immediately gain 2 Coins the first time reached or passed.
- Space 3: unlock second Apprentice during Cleanup.
- Space 4: immediately gain 3 Coins the first time reached or passed; full 3-ceramic Exhibition access.
- Space 5: Imperial Audience; first player takes the 2 VP Imperial Seal.
- Progress VP at game end: 0 / 0 / 2 / 2 / 4 / 8 for spaces 0-5.
- Exhibition: Progress 0-1 up to 1 ceramic; 2-3 up to 2; 4-5 up to 3 plus Shape/Glaze diversity bonuses.